

TIME IN THE SETTLED SYSTEMS

POST-ERBIUM STANDARD

Summary

The **Post-Erbium Standard**, commonly abbreviated **PES**, is the universal timekeeping protocol used throughout the **Settled Systems**. Its central measurement is the **stamp**, a synchronized count of standard minutes maintained across the communications infrastructure operated by **The Fall of Wander and the Rise of Erbium Industries**.

ORIGIN

As interstellar travel and communication expanded, local calendars became increasingly difficult to reconcile. Planets, stations, vessels, and orbital habitats measured days and years according to different rotations, orbits, and artificial cycles.

Erbium Industries introduced PES alongside its interstellar relay network, presenting it as a neutral solution for navigation, commerce, communications, and government administration.

Because most settlements depended on Erbium infrastructure to access the standard, PES became the legal basis for timekeeping throughout the Settled Systems.

THE STAMP

The **stamp** is a continuously increasing count of standard minutes.

Each complete stamp contains two values:

1. The current **lapse**
2. The number of minutes elapsed within that lapse

A complete stamp is written as:

Lapse:Minute PES

Example:

29:08472119 PES

The campaign begins during the **29th Lapse**.

Colloquially, **the stamp** may refer to:

- ◆ The raw PES number
- ◆ The current official time
- ◆ The Erbium-operated timekeeping network
- ◆ An event's legally recognized timestamp

LAPSES

The minute counter can only increase to the maximum value permitted by the PES protocol.

When that value is reached:

1. The minute counter returns to zero
2. The lapse number increases by one
3. PES continues without interruption

The exact duration of a lapse depends on the counter limit established by the protocol.

A lapse is primarily a technical division. Most people use local years, seasons, days, or work cycles in ordinary conversation.

LOCAL TIME CONVERSION

Planets, stations, vessels, and habitats connect to the Erbium relay network and convert the current stamp into a locally useful calendar.

A single stamp might be displayed as:

- ◆ A planetary date and local hour
- ◆ A station cycle and work shift
- ◆ A shipboard mission day
- ◆ A seasonal or agricultural calendar
- ◆ A settlement-specific religious or civil date

Local time systems determine how people ordinarily understand their schedules, birthdays, holidays, and daily routines.

The underlying stamp remains unchanged.

LEGAL USE

PES is the official time standard for:

- ◆ Employment contracts
- ◆ Payroll
- ◆ Equipment leases
- ◆ Shipping manifests
- ◆ Navigation records
- ◆ Transmission logs
- ◆ Insurance claims
- ◆ Criminal and civil deadlines
- ◆ Government filings
- ◆ Corporate service obligations
- ◆ Automated industrial systems

When a local calendar conflicts with the stamp, the PES record is generally treated as legally authoritative.

COMMON TERMINOLOGY

RAW STAMP

The untranslated PES value.

Example:

29:08472119 PES

LOCAL STAMP

A local date or time derived from the current raw stamp.

STAMP DRIFT

A measurable difference between a local clock and the official PES value.

Minor drift may result from faulty hardware or delayed synchronization. Severe drift can invalidate navigation records, contracts, or automated safety logs.

STAMP AUTHORITY

The relay, server cluster, or institutional record recognized as the official source for a disputed stamp.

Erbium-controlled systems are usually treated as the default authority.

STAMPED

Officially recorded by a PES-connected system.

“The inspection was stamped before the pressure loss.”

OFF-STAMP

Disconnected from PES, operating without synchronization, or absent from the official record.

“That settlement has been off-stamp for eleven local days.”

GHOST MINUTES

Time experienced or worked locally that does not appear in the accepted PES record.

Ghost minutes may occur during relay outages, damaged transmissions, synchronization errors, or disputes over which server held stamp authority.

Erbium Industries commonly refuses to recognize ghost minutes for payroll, lease compliance, or service-credit calculations.

SOCIAL AND POLITICAL SIGNIFICANCE

Erbium Industries publicly describes PES as a shared civic utility that allows the Settled Systems to function as a unified civilization.

In practice, Erbium controls much of the infrastructure that determines when an action legally occurred.

This gives the company considerable influence over:

- ◆ Whether labor hours are recognized
- ◆ Whether a shipment arrived on time
- ◆ When a lease expires
- ◆ Whether a service obligation has been fulfilled

- ◆ Which version of a disputed event becomes official
- ◆ Whether activity during an outage legally occurred

Independent settlements frequently maintain private backups, mechanical clocks, or locally signed records in case an Erbium stamp is challenged.

CORPORATE LANGUAGE

Before Erbium, every world kept its own time. We gave the Settled Systems a shared future.

One standard. One record. One settled civilization.

If it was not stamped, it did not happen.